

Revised Research Plan

Objectives (What we want to learn)

Which, if any, prototypes meet user needs identified in Needfind?

The current highly refined prototypes, the Stress Lock App, the Heartlock App, and the Stress Monitoring Band, all meet specific components of user needs.

The Stress Lock Application, acting as a notification system to incentivize time away from stressful phone apps, directly covers the needs of distraction friction instead of restriction, as well as a calming approach to stress reflection. The notifications that we have planned for this prototype are meant to not be direct messages that patronize users, but rather gentle reminders to influence self-reflection, asking the user if they were aware of the stress, and just remind them that they had downloaded the app for a reason.

The Heartlock App takes a different approach to the same problems of users, this time instead distracting users from the stress intentionally by drawing their attention towards a stress-relieving game. The impact is more direct, but covered by the mask of a game, but only through usability testing and further prototyping can the right games to inhibit stress-relief can these games be modified.

The stress monitoring band is an applicable solution that could very well mend into the other prototypes; it required a bit more of a technical solution, and trust from the user, but it would be the most efficient if it were to work correctly. If stress levels can be measured through software data coming straight from the user, the solutions towards stress can be much more defined in evidence of working.

Overall, all prototypes meet user needs identified during interviews and analysis, but with different angles and approaches. Currently, the best prototype for INZONE has been a planned mix of each prototype: the revised stress lock app, a notification system with stress-relief games that look to decrease your heart rate while scrolling on possibly stressing apps. This prototype has replaced the current model for the Stress Lock App, and so will be used as part of the prototyping interviews.

Assumptions: What do you assume you will find? (aka hypotheses)

Through further breakdown and analysis, we assume as a group that our prototype will show efficient usability, but must be further tested and refined in the notifications that it allows and the games that it includes so that lowered stress levels can be accurately proven.

Participants: Who do you need to participate?

We require participants that meet our original criteria for interviewees, namely people who:

- Fall within the original age range (18-22)
- Would agree to certain requirements of being affected by:
 - Their phones

- Certain apps
- Stress-inducing environments via certain apps
- Currently in school or have a job

How do you plan to recruit them?

Organized sampling through a likely location of people who match our needed requirements: Doe Library. This area is a high-traffic studying area of UC Berkeley students of many different majors. This will work as the best place for us to recruit with a wide net of people that still fall within our needed participation requirements.

Protocol:

What method are you using? Hint: in-depth interview and usability test.

In-depth interviews: Guided interview questions that ask similar questions to the original needfinding interviews, but with further questions that ask about the prototypes and recruits' thoughts and opinions.

Usability testing: Having the participants use each of the possible prototypes for approximately 1 minute after scrolling on a “stressing” app for 2 minutes. Testing their bpm throughout that time.

How long will each participant session take to run?

Each participant session should take, assumably, approximately 5 minutes to complete.

Physical stimuli include the band that will measure levels of heart rate and blood pressure.

Digital stimuli will come in the form of prototype games as part of the current running model for the application.

What stimuli are you using? This is usually a brief text description of your prototypes.

We will be using the actual software prototypes from our high defined prototype section when conducting these interviews, having recruits interact with them after spending time on their phone. We are also looking into having a bpm monitor attached to the recruits with their consent to help see fluctuations in their stress levels.